GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

April 4th, 2025
Week 14
Volume 271, Issue 1179

Highlights:

- **Tariff time.**
- **Reciprocal moves.**
- **Hard liner.**
- **Post-tariff world.**
- **Troubled Waters.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"I think one day you'll find that you're the hero you've been looking for."

– Jimmy Stewart

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

TARIFF TRUFFLE!

As Trump's massive gamble on tariff wars kicked into high gear over 'Liberation Day' this week, global stock markets took unkindly to the tariffs as they were decimated and fell over 10%, with over USD 3 Trillion being wiped out from investor pockets, as consumers globally have yet to see a dramatic impact filter through to their collective pockets. As nations retaliated across the board almost immediately and China even slapped reciprocal tariffs on the U.S., it maybe sooner rather than later that the impacts of this situation are already at the doorsteps of exporting nations (to the U.S.) as the situation is still freshly unfolding across all nations. And although President Trump is known for taking hard line positions as he golfed while the markets were in free fall, Republicans and Democrats are reportedly taking steps to pass law that would curb the powers of the Executive Branch through the unfolding lunacy, and the outpouring of protests may lead to a softened (or at the very least a negotiated position) from Trump's side somewhere down the line – hopefully much sooner rather than later. Notwithstanding, the immediate effects were certainly dramatic as this week, oil suffered the most egregious of collapses falling to USD 62 / barrel, a number not since seen since August 2021. And with OPEC+ countries vowing to increase supply as global demand eases on the back of tariffs and an uncertain economic future, global trade also seems to be taking a hit with the Baltic's dry sea freight index slumped another 3.3% down to a one month low.

The global ship recycling sector also witnessed some interesting activity as not only have local steel plate prices continued to climb in India, but they also fell in China and flatlined in both Bangladesh and Pakistan. On the currencies front, while some reported improvements (India), others declined with Turkey surprising the industry, reporting no change this week. Recycling activity too has somewhat inevitably been picking up in sub-continent markets over these last few weeks as the number of deliveries greatly improved of late, and this week has seen the various waterfronts take a beating with no fresh arrivals in Bangladesh, while India and Pakistan snared just one each. Even Bangladeshi prices that climbed briefly following on a dearth of tonnage, seem to have settled as there is no tonnage to bid on, and Indian & Pakistani recyclers remain cautious & tentative in their offerings on fresh tonnage in light of the recent U.S. sanctions saga, while simultaneously observing markets to see what the overall impact on prices and potential renewed dumping of cheap Chinese steel into the sub-continent could spell for their purchases, before presenting fresh offers on tonnage at numbers that could conceivably be far lower in a post tariff world.

With minimum activity taking place in Bangladesh, Pakistan, and Turkey thanks to Eid celebrations and holidays that have kept most markets closed through this week, the outcome of Bangladeshi restriction on imports remains unresolved on the back of the March 31st deadline for local recyclers within which, infrastructure updates at all domestic ship recycling yards were to commence, leaving the fate of pending deliveries through the upcoming tide(s), an uncertainty. Overall, while we may be witnessing an overreaction to a hardline, exaggerated, and thoughtless action from the highest office in the U.S., rather than collectively forecasting doom and gloom for global trade, a more pragmatic long-term view may be needed to navigate through these troubled waters together.

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 14 of 2025 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

VOICEMAIL!

Best placed.

It has been a voicemail week for the Chattogram Choppers as the ship recycling fraternity was collectively celebrating Eid and the end of the Holy month of Ramadan this week, resulting in steel plate prices that have started Q2 2025, flatlined at the bottom of the pool where they have been for about 7 months now. Moreover, even the 2024 experiment by the Bangladeshi government to permit the Taka to be controlled by market forces, saw it decline over 21 basis points / BDT 11 during this time, ended the week at BDT 121.82, likely to pass BDT 122 in the next week(s) as the pending 37% tariff truffle against Bangladesh awaits delivery to its economy.

Questions arise.

The key 'beneficiary' of these tariffs, which are currently at 20%, will be the Readymade Garments (RMG) sector and is expected to be hit the hardest as they have been, ever since the collapse of the government in June 2024 that resulted in local violence, rioting, and ongoing unemployment. Moreover, despite being the firmest placed sub-continent market atop GMS's market rankings, local recyclers have started to question what the overall impact on prices further down the line might be, as the markets saw local offers being scaled back by about USD 5 - USD 10/LDT whilst other end buyers decided to take a wait and watch approach entirely.

Deadline to extend?

And despite the supply of tonnage being at concerning levels over the last few weeks and freight rates cooling off this week as well, the expectation that the BSBRA will again extend the HKC deadline to begin yard upgrades from March 31st to a later date remains up in the air as authorities and governmental offices remain closed on the back of ongoing Eid holidays and end buyers are still pressuring authorities for an extension, as they remains keen to fill their plots before the HKC comes into force on June 26th, 2025 and certainly as the immediate future of incoming deliveries hangs in the balance.

Weakening prices and the ongoing diminished supply of viable units also saw a drop in the number of market and private local fixtures, and subsequent arrivals at the local waterfront, where local recyclers reported no fresh arrivals this week, other than a handful of prior deliveries, including vessel 'THREE STAR' that had been stranded at anchorage since January of this year.

Dry Week

On the local economic front, the nation recorded the largest ever international personal remittances back into the country to the tune of aver USD 3 Billion, which saw domestic reserves being actively replenished through the volatile uncertainty that is currently affecting the economy and the decisions of the interim administration. And due to the ongoing holidays, there remains little of importance to report from Bangladesh, as Week 14 winds to a halt with nothing of significance to report.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

ALERT 'N' ALIVE!

Despite being the most sensitive of sub-continent markets to unfolding global events and global market turmoil, India the most part, has been for cautiously waiting on the sidelines to see how Trump's tariff tantrums play out before committing afresh on any of the slim pickings of recycling vessels that are currently floating around the bidding tables.

Most sensitive

And despite Trump announcing 26% tariffs on India across the board, the reaction from India has been surprisingly filtered thus far, with no news of retaliatory tariffs or retreating vessel offerings (as yet), especially as domestic fundamentals continue to collectively strengthen through the week. Not only did local steel plate prices climb another USD 9/Ton to over USD 473.56/Ton (pushing local purchases on dry vessels further in the green), but even the Indian Rupee firmed down to Rs. 85.50 (from the highs approaching Rs. 88), providing further confidence to Alang buyers, especially as their Bangladeshi counterparts are pulling back on their offers by up to USD 10/Ton this week and Pakistani recyclers continue to take a bite out of India's tonnage buffet.

Limited supply.

And while most of the market tonnage in recent weeks has filtered through to the far better positioned Bangladeshi market, with India being the one destination that has been left to only taking HKC only limited vessels and specialist units, the recent global market turmoil may still see more vessels arrive for recycling in the near future and a greater supply of vessels are therefore expected to head to India and Pakistan later into Q2. Whether levels hold at prevailing rates remains to be seen, especially as some recyclers are already taking the opportune time to talking down the market, to take stock of unfolding market falls. But the reality is that steel prices and local currencies have not been impacted to such a dramatic overall effect (as yet), to justify a sudden decline in offerings.

Not dramatic.

Meanwhile, Alang anchorage continues to simmer on the number of its local arrivals with only a small LDT arrival of a supply vessel, as India seems increasingly destined for an empty port position, especially in the face of all of the global craziness unfolding. India's economy, however, seems to be on the right trajectory especially as the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) announced that it would likely cut interest rates by 25 basis points in the coming week, indicating a greater sense of urgency to induce local spending after the recent tax breaks.

And while this could further assist India's ship recycling sector on large U.S. Dollar transactions when the time comes, the lack of tonnage at the bidding tables is likely to see this market spend the next week(s) on a quieter note.

Quiet.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

MINI REVIVAL?

Smaller LDT deals.

A mini revival of sorts in Pakistan, bought on primarily due to India's recently diminishing levels that inadvertently thrust the Gadani Gang into 2nd place on the market rankings, has brought the Pakistani market back into the picture of late, with a series of smaller LDT, mostly local Middle Eastern owned, geographically positioned sales to local buyers – and this week was no exception with another fresh arrival and with the most amount of LDT in the Indian sub-continent markets this week, given that 20K LDT is currently delivered or lying in wait at anchorage awaiting delivery.

No impact.

The overall impact of Pakistan's recent moves in the sub-continent ship recycling markets has been rather limited so far however, with most of the larger LDT deals of the year (including a cape, several LNGs and larger tankers) ending up either in Bangladesh or neighboring India. However, Pakistani buyers need to really engage on incoming LDT after having spent a prolonged period on the sidelines, in order to sustain this momentum. Notwithstanding, fundamentals are deliberately conspiring to keep local offerings in check, especially as local steel plate prices lie flatlined for the last week at USD 624/Ton (almost USD 40/Ton lower than previous highs), all while the Pakistani Rupee loses another 26 basis points, to end the week at PKR 280.34 against the U.S. Dollar.

Taking seriously.

The recent tariffs placed across the globe have also not spared the Pakistani economy where Trump announced an additional 29% blanket tariffs on all imports from Pakistan, which could seriously affect Pakistan's textiles and garments exports (like Bangladesh). And while this could spell disaster for the domestic economy, which is once against in the thralls of rising inflation, Pakistan's Finance Minister sees a silver lining via opening possible new avenues for negotiating a "balanced economic relationship", not only with the U.S., but with other nations and economies worldwide. And although this strategy maybe present viable long-term opportunities for the nation, in the short-term, the domestic economic situation will likely dip for the worse.

HKC upgrades?

Notwithstanding, all that is unfolding, it is good to see some recycling transactions finally being concluded to local recyclers, all while yard upgrades are yet to be taken seriously, with several end users reportedly only now starting infrastructure works and investments in order to get up to HKC standards ahead of its entry into force in June of this year. For the rest, it maybe an even longer time on the sidelines until their certifications come through.

Overall, with Raman holidays keeping the local ship recycling community distracted with celebrations, the week ended on a quiet note, just like the rest of its sub-continent neighbors.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

JUST LIKE THE REST…

10%

Similar to the performances of its sub-continent ship recycling associates, Aliaga recyclers spent the week busy in celebrations with nothing to report from their end this week. No movement in local or import steel plate prices reported, no sales reported, and the biggest surprise of all, no movement reported from the Turkish Lira, which, for the first time in a very long time, reported no change this week. Moreover, being the one ship recycling destination to have faced only 10% of Trump's tariffs this week, which it is seeking to negotiate further down, the economic hammer from Trump's recent actions might mercifully not affect this market as bad. But to what extent is that any better from what Turkey has been going through over the last couple of years?

As tonnage availability remains amiss, there remains nothing to report from Turkey, yet again.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 14 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Stable**	450 / LDT	470 / LDT	480 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Stable**	445 / LDT	465 / LDT	475 / LDT
3	India	**Weak**	440 / LDT	460 / LDT	470 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Stable**	280 / LDT	290 / LDT	300 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- *Onions were used to treat wounds during the French and Indian War.*
- *The energy required to show a new Instagram post from Cristiano Ronaldo to each of his followers could power a house for several years.*
- *A group of butterflies flew across the Atlantic Ocean without stopping. It took them only about eight days.*
- *Children with cystic fibrosis are no longer automatically eligible for the Make-A-Wish Foundation because a new drug works so well that these kids are now expected to have an essentially normal lifespan.*
- *Your body carries literal pieces of your mom—and maybe your grandmother, siblings, aunts, and uncles.*
- *The generative-AI boom is on pace to cost more than the Apollo space missions.*
- *Early space capsules lacked handholds and footholds on the outside, and some spacewalking astronauts really struggled to make it back on board.*
- *Around the world, more than 10,000 barcodes are scanned every second.*
- *McDonald's cooked its French fries in beef tallow until 1990.*
- *The fast-food giant also grills its beef patties for exactly 42 seconds.*
- *California grizzly bears were once mostly vegan, but over time, humans made them more carnivorous.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
April 10 – Mahavir Jayanti April 14 – Dr. Ambedkar Jayanti April 18 – Good Friday April 20 – Easter Sunday	March 27 – April 05 April 12 – April 17 April 26 – May 03

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
April 14 – Bengali New Year	April 12 – April 15 April 27 – April 30

BANK HOLIDAYS		
CHINA	**PAKISTAN**	**TURKEY**
May 01 – 05 – Labor Day May 31 – June 02 – Dragon Boat Holiday	May 01 – Labor Day	April 23 – National Sovereignty & Children's Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of April 04, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Athena	1,178	Supply Vessel	Arrived April 03
2	*Ion*	*3,868*	*Chemical Tanker*	*Delivered March 29*
Total Tonnage		**5,046**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of April 04, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Elli*	*9,242*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered April 01*
2	*Equator*	*42,649*	*Tanker*	*Delivered March 30*
3	Rich Anna	1,011	General Cargo	Arrived March 26
4	***Three Star***	***7,627***	***Bulk Carrier***	***Delivered March 29***
		60,529		

GADANI - Port Position as of April 04, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Atlantic 22*	*5,219*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered March 26*
2	DSM Star	8,000	Bulk Carrier	Arrived April 02
3	*Marco*	*975*	*Standby-Safety Vessel*	*Delivered March 27*
4	*Neptune Star 25*	*5,471*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered March 25*
Total Tonnage		**19,665**		

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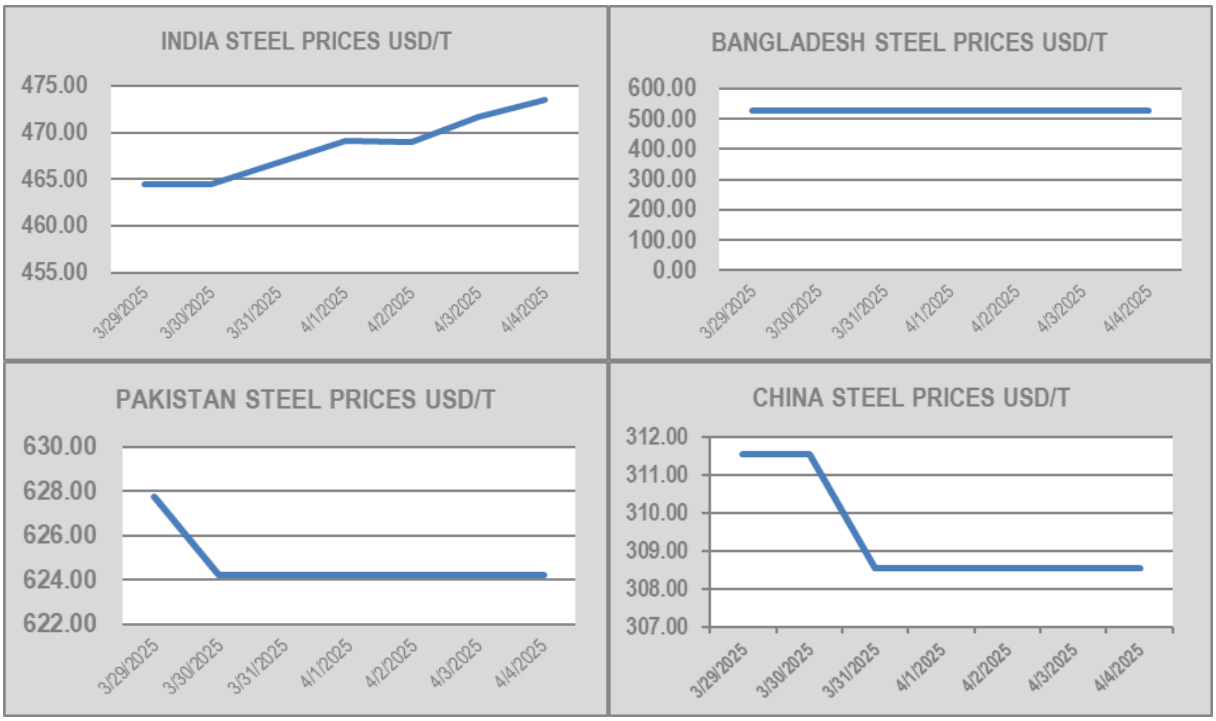
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
3/29/2025	464.49	39,700.00	627.79	175,000.00	529.41	63,000.00	311.57
3/30/2025	464.49	39,700.00	624.22	175,000.00	529.41	63,000.00	311.57
3/31/2025	466.83	39,900.00	624.22	175,000.00	529.41	63,000.00	308.57
4/1/2025	469.17	40,100.00	624.22	175,000.00	529.41	63,000.00	308.57
4/2/2025	469.01	40,100.00	624.22	175,000.00	529.41	63,000.00	308.57
4/3/2025	471.73	40,300.00	624.22	175,000.00	529.41	63,000.00	308.57
4/4/2025	473.56	40,300.00	624.22	175,000.00	529.41	63,000.00	308.57



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